

Open-back princess mini dress

EU38 sewing guide . 11 pieces . 2.1 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Bodice Center Front - cut 1 on fold
Bodice Side Front - cut 2
Bodice Center Back - cut 2
Bodice Side Back - cut 2
Front Neck Facing - cut 1 on fold, interface
Back Neck Facing - cut 2, interface
Skirt Center Front - cut 1 on fold
Skirt Side Front - cut 2
Skirt Center Back - cut 2 (center back seam)
Skirt Side Back - cut 2
Open Back Facing (round) - cut 1 on fold, interface

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope, underbust - sew a quick muslin (test version) from cheap fabric first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled: pieces marked 'on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice.
4. Fuse interfacing to the neck facings.
5. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
6. Staystitch the curved princess edges too, for the same reason.
7. Sew each bodice princess seam: pin center panel to side panel matching the bust notch, sew, clip the side panel's curve over the bust inside the seam allowance, press toward the center.
8. Sew the bodice shoulder seams and press them open.
9. Sew the front and back neck facings together at the shoulders; finish the facing's outer edge (zigzag, overlock or turn 5 mm and stitch).
10. Attach the facing to the neckline right sides together, leaving the last 2 cm free at each center back edge (the zipper goes there later). Trim to 6 mm, clip into the curve every 2 cm.
11. Understitch: press the seam allowance toward the facing and stitch it to the facing 2 mm from the seam - this keeps the facing rolled inside. Turn, press, tack at the shoulder seams.
12. Open back: fuse interfacing to the open-back facing and finish its outer edge.

13. Pin the open-back facing to the back RIGHT sides together, matching the marked round opening. Stitch exactly on the marked line all the way around.
14. Slash the opening inside the stitched line (through both layers); clip the curves and corners to within 2 mm of the stitching.
15. Turn the facing through the opening to the inside, roll the seam to the edge, press, then understitch or topstitch 2 mm from the opening edge.
16. Sew the bodice side seams.
17. Finish armholes with bias binding (sleeveless).
18. Sew each skirt gore seam (center panel to side panel, matching the tip notch), pressing toward the center.
19. Sew the skirt seams (leave the center back seam open where the zipper will go), then join bodice to skirt at the waist seam, matching side seams and lining the gore seams up with the bodice princess seams as closely as possible.
20. Insert an invisible zipper in the center back through bodice and skirt: install the zipper BEFORE closing the seam below it, then close the rest of the seam.
21. Fold the free facing ends back over the zipper tape and hand-tack them down so the edge sits clean against the zipper.
22. Try it on, then hem with a 2 cm double fold.